

Find your common ground

A 20-minute opener before today's Unit 1 pp.8-9 material. Purpose: get all three of them actually talking to each other, and give Isabella a real, structured way in. This is not a mingle — with only three students, it works better as one shared conversation than a stand-and-rotate mingle.

Isabella is brand new. She trialled 15 Sep and confirmed staying 16 Sep — Martina and Víctor don't know her yet, and this activity exists mainly to fix that. Make sure she isn't just answering last: on two or three questions, ask her first, and let Martina and Víctor react to her answer rather than the other way round.

TIMING **20 minutes total** then straight into pp.8-9

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
0-2 min	Hand out each student's own copy (it's pre-labelled with their name and the other two students' names in the columns). Explain: they take turns asking each other the ten questions out loud, as one group of three — not written silently, not a rotating mingle. Whoever answers, the other two write a short note in their own grid.
2-14 min	Work through the ten questions together. You don't have to go in strict order — follow the energy, but make sure all ten get asked and everyone answers all ten. Use the follow-up prompts below if an answer is one word.
14-19 min	Stop them and set Step 2: as a group, agree two or three things true of all three of them (or at least two of the three), and write them in the box at the bottom of their sheet. Circulate, don't supply answers — if they're stuck, point back at a question where two answers matched.
19-20 min	Quick share-out: each says one thing the group has in common. Then move straight on — today continues with FCEI_Unit1_pp8-9_17Sep2026, the existing Unit 1 pages 8-9 material, for the remaining ~40 minutes.

QUESTIONS

The ten, with a follow-up if the first answer is thin

one is the Valencia question,
non-negotiable

	QUESTION	FOLLOW-UP TO THROW IN
1	What kind of music do you actually listen to, when nobody else is choosing the playlist?	<i>Any Spanish or Valencian artists in there, or is it all English-language?</i>
2	What's the last series you got hooked on?	<i>Subtitled, dubbed, or original English? Martina learnt most of her English from series — worth drawing out.</i>
3	Is there a food you could eat every day and never get tired of?	<i>Is it a home dish, or something you'd order out?</i>
4	What do you usually do on a lazy Saturday with no plans?	<i>Morning person or the whole day starts at midday?</i>
5	Have you got a favourite place to hang out in Valencia?	<i>Push for a real place name, not just "the beach" — which beach, which barrio, which café.</i>
6	Two weeks off, enough money — where would you go?	<i>Víctor was in Shrewsbury this summer, Martina in Toulouse — would they go back, or somewhere new?</i>
7	Do you play a sport, or is there one you'd love to try?	<i>Team sport or solo? Ever tried it in a club here in Valencia?</i>
8	A public figure you genuinely admire — why?	<i>Push past the name to the reason; that's the actual speaking practice.</i>
9	Something you're weirdly good at that would surprise people?	<i>If they freeze, model your own first — it lowers the stakes fast.</i>
10	Friends, alone, or somewhere in between for a free evening?	<i>Ask if that changes on weekdays versus weekends.</i>